Ru'aun Telegram

11th Edition - January 2029

(Week of 06 April 2026)

----- **Election News:** The Commonwealth at the Polls -----

2500 seats were up for grabs this month, as voters across five nations took to the polls to decide who represents their nation to the Commonwealth. Most especially, Terre France had recently transitioned from a dependency of Deutscheslanden to an independent country under its traditional name: Solagne. Deutscheslanden as well has seen a rebrand after its voters approved reforms to rename the nation to Eisenwald — its historical name. With hope in the air, the Commonwealth elections came to prove how these shifting tides worldwide would be reflected at the ballot box.

Three camps have been of particular notice: Volt, the Phoenix Patriots, and the New Left. Volt is a transnational party based in Astra Nova, the Patriots are supported by the United Alternative-Eisenwald National People's Party coalition, and the New Left is led by the Ruaunese Workers' Party and adjacent socialist parties. These three coalitions across the Seijo Sea vie for power across the spectrum.

On 13 January 2029, the second Saturday of the year, voters would make it through the snowy cold to vote for the future of the Commonwealth. This is what they voted for.

"Phoenix Parliamentary Election Results

New Left - 44.84% | 1121 Seats

Green Coalition - 4.12% | 103 Seats

Volt+ - 27.64% | 691 Seats

Conservative Shield - 4.28% | 107 Seats

Phoenix Patriots - 17.96% | 449 Seats

Non-Aligned MPs - 1.16% | 29 Seats"

- Commonwealth Election Commission

By numbers, the New Left prevailed, though through the Ruaunese Workers' Party's sheer size and influence in Ru'aun. Volt polled far above its size, embodying the goal of unity which the parliament was intended to accomplish. In Ce'leste and Solagne especially, Volt polled higher than on average, most likely resulting from traditions of neutrality and democracy.

The New Left established the Coalition for Unity, yet Volt was offered the position to select the first Commonwealth President. Thus, Aurélie Trouvé would become the first President, with Felix Argyle the first Vice President. Trouvé was approved by the New Left, as their leadership sought to embrace the

Commonwealth's goal of transnational unity. Argyle was a surprising pick for the Vice Presidency. However, as the leader of the Green Coalition and Green Party in the RWP, he has strong connections with the left.

The Phoenix Patriots captured a large portion of the Phoenix Parliament. To the surprise of many, this was positively regarded by many conservatives. TelePoll notes that in Ru'aun, some voters traditionally for the Libertarians and PDP supported the Patriots, with 58% of this voter base voting with the right. Political scientists are forecasting that this may reflect in the upcoming Ruaunese elections, yet it is uncertain if Commonwealth politics will reflect on the general population.

For the centre-right Conservative Party, the election was widely regarded as a disaster. Backed by the Libertarian Party of Ru'aun, Phoenix Democratic Party, and Solagne Liberal Party, it struggled to retain its reach outside of Solagne. TelePoll noted that many voters saw inaction by the centre-right as the main reason for their rightward shift, though it also noted that Solagne has had a history of strong, centrist coalitions.

----- **Scientific News:** Progress, Reform, and Renewing Foundations ----

With elections sorted, focus on scientific expansion was at last at the forefront of policy. RASA would see the integration of Akira in an advisory position, yet also the continuation of a long-overdue bureaucratic overhaul. RASA and RSRO had long operated as distinct organisations, yet RASA has held the duty of converging the goals of the divisions. This has long created rifts in the organisation, and RASA scientists and leaders alike have long warned of the consequences of this. With the gap between Apollo VII and VIII, RASA and Parliament have taken the time to implement reforms to the space programme.

RASA's primary focus has been on repairing the organisation's hierarchy, as the past chains of command from RSRO and RACA are intertwined and complex. The hallmark of these reforms has been, essentially, the abolition of the independent leadership of RSRO and RACA. Instead, RASA has merged relevant divisions, rather than arbitrarily dividing them by past lines. Despite the bold intent, these major shake-ups caused backlash from the RSRO management.

"RSRO has long held autonomy in RASA, as we pursued a more equipment-oriented development cycle rather than RACA's experimental development. RSRO itself provided the very equipment in RACA's past experiments, and it seems nonsensical to relinquish our authority."

- RSRO Former Director George Burton

In the primary internal debate, former RSRO staff have been advocating for a change of the hierarchy from a RACA-centric one to either an equal or RSRO-centric one. Parliament has attempted to mediate between the two RASA factions, and a temporary compromise has been made. RSRO will be allowed to gradually transition into a merged framework, while RACA must also make compromises on who is elected as leadership. Though a strenuous deal, it has allowed the Administration to remain on schedule for Apollo VIII and Diana III.

During this time of large-scale bureaucratic overhaul, Parliament made another seemingly small yet major decision: the Ruaunese State Technology Company has been renamed to the Atlas Corporation.

This comes in line with recent trade agreements abroad, as the Government presumably seeks to capitalise on new markets by appealing to civilian consumers. This is a sharp pivot from the state-first approach, as the company goes from appealing to the government (e.g. Akira is supported by Atlas) to appealing to civilians. Especially, with consumer electronics having been on the decline in Ru'aun, Parliament seeks to improve the quality of life in the digital era.

The past half-year has been a buzzing one for science, and the people will have to see what fruit these advances bear.

----- **Political News:** The Campaign Trail Blaze -----

With major shifts in Ru'aun and the Commonwealth, the electoral race has intensified. Ein X and Michael Valcrom have made several prominent appearances in Everdusk and Scaleswind, appealing to southern voters. Chairman Lycan and Leon Legacy have made major appearances in the Greater Falconclaw Area and the East Coast, appealing to northern voters. Political analysts have worried that these choices may reinforce the idea of a North-South divide, as TelePoll notes sharp differences in how people in these regions identify themselves.

"In the North, we observed major congregations of left-wing and especially Ruaunese Workers' Party voters, especially in the urban areas of Greater Falconclaw and the Phoenix Drop-New Meteli region. In the south, you see a congregation of more right-wing voters, particularly the United Alternative. The Libertarians and Phoenix Centre Party draw their support from the Southwest and Wyvern Mountain regions. Volt Sylvastra draws its support from Neu Freiberg primarily, but also in some pockets along the Celestian border. This fragmentation and polarisation of politics is reflected in the results of the elections, whereas the urban vote leads the polls, while the expansive rural vote pushes the UA into the spotlight."

- Steve Carter, TelePoll Commentator

Volt Sylvastra has, in recent months, captivated both Northern and Southern voters alike. A non-negligible proportion of the urban vote seems to be swayed to Volt, as noted by increasing turnouts at Volt rallies in Neu Freiberg and Nahakra. However, the RWP continues to dominate the polls, having led the nation through its greatest eras of prosperity. Many young voters seem torn on who to vote for: the party that promised them continuity or the party that promises them peace?

"The Syndies in government have made something clear to me; I have a life waiting for me. Yet, at night, I can't help but think if we should accept the world we live in… Should we sacrifice peace for our ever-so coveted continuity? Is the cost worth it? The Syndies promise me our future as a nation, but the Internationalists promise me our future as the world… What future do I want? A future that I live in or a future I may live to see? That's the real question…"

- Alex Martinex, 24-year-old Falconclaw office worker

In the conservative camp, a far different debate has been occurring — one that has been ongoing since the 2000s — Who leads the right? For half a century before, the Free Democratic Party held that role. However, after the merger of the major classical liberal parties, the Phoenix Centre Front dominated. Then, in 2011, the party faltered to the Libertarian wave. In 2017, the centre-right collapsed, as the RWP

rose to power. Since then, a fierce competition has ensued as to whether the United Alternative or the centrist parties can represent the conservatives.

In recent times, it seems the conservative answer to this debate is clear: only the United Alternative can save the right. TelePoll sees this reflected in their recent survey, as roughly 60% of conservative voters intend to vote with the UA; a rise from the 48% noted in the last election and a sharp increase since 2023 (whereas only 27% voted far-right).

“The right is about many things, but two things in particular are important to us: economics and identity. For one, as we live in this socialist society, we should value the money people have entrusted to us, rather than blowing it on vast projects with no clear benefit for decades. On identity, we mustn’t surrender who we are to stand with foreign powers. We must preserve our identity, for that is who we are, and it defines us.”

- Joseph Rogan, United Alternative, Scaleswind

All in all, democracy faces tests on both sides of the spectrum. Growing pains ripple through both the left and right. With elections looming, the nation holds its breath as it waits for the coming shifts.

----- **Editorial:** Shifting Currents for Culture -----

Presented by Konrad von Flammenberg

With all the chaos nationwide and globally, we must take a break and reflect on who we are as a people. Ru’aun is an accepting and unique country, where discrimination against communities ended long ago. The thriving LGBTQ+ community in Ru’aun has grown, and even the smaller werewolf and Meif’wa diaspora are on a rebound. Truly, times have changed vastly in the past twenty years.

When you go outside, you’ll find that some rather unique fashion trends have become popular. You find that crop tops are seen as an acceptable unisex clothing item, which is vastly different from their more female-centric view in Tugana. As well, it has become more socially normalised to be openly a femboy. Thigh-high socks are quite popular for both genders, and NookExpress has noted that pawed cat-themed socks are the most popular. These small details reflect on our society’s creativity.

Expanding on the uniqueness of fashion lately, it also seems that collars have interestingly become more common and acceptable. In a string of street interviews, we noted that this trend comes from self-expression but also comfort at times. On self-expression, the clothing-optional law has been a relatively popular one, as people become increasingly comfortable with themselves and their bodies.

When we look in the mirror, we see a nation that’s become much more than anything else in the world. We are united in our diversity. We are all unique in our own ways, and that’s what makes Ru’aun a special place for all of us. Ru’aun is more than its politics, but it's about its people. Our individual identities are why we are Ru’aun. Never forget that we are ourselves.

SUMMARY:

January 2029 has been a month of motion for Ru'aun and the Commonwealth. The Phoenix Parliament has held its first elections, with Volt+ surging above expectations and Aurélie Trouvé becoming the

Commonwealth's first elected President. At home, RASA continues its quiet revolution, restructuring its foundations while Apollo VIII and Diana III wait on the horizon. On the campaign trail, the nation grows louder as the RWP, the United Alternative, and Volt Sylvastra each make their case to a divided but engaged electorate. And beneath the politics, Ru'aun remains what it has always been: a nation of people finding their own way forward, one step at a time.